

In This Moment

Dr David Paul, 1955 to 2023, went from Royal Marines officer to engineer to one of the most quietly copied trading teachers alive. **His whole philosophy fits in four words: discipline, simplicity, expectancy, presence.**

01 The moment

A goalkeeper cannot know where the ball is going. **He can only be set, balanced and awake when it is struck.** Over one shot that looks like luck. Over a hundred shots it is the whole job. Paul taught trading the same way.

- **Presence over prediction.** Being fully in the current bar beats having a view about the next hour. A view is a story. Attention is a skill.
- **Simplicity over complexity.** More indicators feel like more control. They mostly add places to hide from a decision you already know how to make.
- **Discipline over impulse.** The rule you wrote when calm outranks the certainty you feel when hot, every single time.
- **One thing, done the same way.** Paul traded a small number of setups for decades rather than collecting new ones.

02 Expectancy

The goalkeeper does not ask whether he will save the next shot. He asks what his save rate is across a season. **That shift, from the next one to the average one, is the centre of Paul's teaching.**

- **Expectancy is the only honest scoreboard.** Win rate times average win, minus loss rate times average loss. A trader can be right most of the time and still go broke.
- **A loss inside the plan is not a mistake.** It is a cost of doing business and it was priced in before entry.
- **A win outside the plan is not a success.** It is a bill that has not arrived yet.
- **The edge shows up in the aggregate or not at all.** Any single trade is close to noise, which is why judging yourself by it is the fastest way to abandon a working method.

THE ONE IDEA

Prediction asks what will happen next. Expectancy asks what happens on average across a hundred repetitions. **Only one of those two questions has an answer, and it is not the interesting one.**

SOURCES & NOTE

Sources: Dr Ulrik Vangstrup, In. This. Moment., a biography of Dr David Paul; Published David Paul lectures and interviews, 2010 to 2022; Tom Hougaard on Paul as his mentor.

Dr David Paul lived 1955 to 2023 and did not publish a trading book of his own. This guide is built from a biography written about him and from his recorded talks. Educational, not financial advice.